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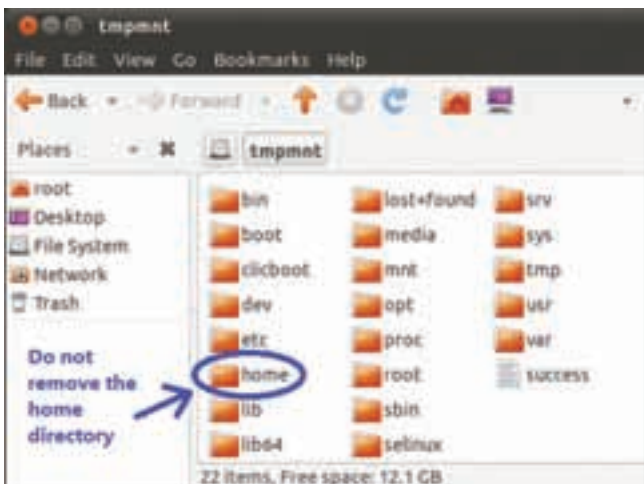
Available Storage on linux						
Device	Size	F. Enc.	Type	FS Type	Label	Mount Point
dev/sda	18.00 GB		QEMU-HARDDISK			
dev/sda1	8.99 GB	F	Linux native	Ext4		/home
dev/sda2	9.01 GB	F	Linux native	Ext4		/
dev/sda3	2.00 GB	F	Linux swap	Swap		/swap

A separate /home will make it easy for you in the future

once again is to not format the partition where installation has to be done. You can once again set the UID and GID of the new user you would create. If that is not possible to be done by the installer, you can follow the steps described in the previous method to change the user and group ownership of the directory using the root account.

Remember however that none of these techniques will allow you to preserve system-wide settings such as network connections because such settings reside on the /etc/ directory. While it might be a good idea to copy-paste /etc/ as well, it can be hazardous in many ways. Software features change from one version to another and so do their configuration files at times. If you use the older configuration files, it may break something or the other.

Some important files in the /etc/ should always be recreated by the installation (e.g. /etc/fstab). Although not mandatory, old files can create large problems. At other times, presence or absence of old symlinks of config files can also create trouble. So it's best to configure a few settings, such as network connections by hand after a new distro installation. However, to save personal files and preferences



If you have no separate partition for /home, make sure you do not remove the /home directory when removing other content from the / partition

(such as firefox settings, your old Evolution mailbox and preferences, settings stored in empathy for chat etc.)

There would, however, be no worries past reading this small guide about preserving your files, settings and preferences when inserting the Linux disk into the tray. 



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